

Extender-DB: the catalog and its standards, both as data

A walkthrough of what was built on feat/extender-db in dotfiles-agents

Every number in this deck was queried live from the database it describes

2026-07-20 · _meta/extender-db · briefing for Henry

The problem

Curating a growing catalog of skills, agents, and hooks by re-reading files doesn't scale.

- The repo has strong distribution machinery (roster, drift guards, marketplace generator) but had no analysis substrate
- Questions we couldn't ask cheaply: which skills lack worked examples? what frontmatter keys does no spec define? how conformant are we to Anthropic's authoring guidance?
- Three jobs need one substrate: organize, monitor, improve

The key idea

The standards themselves are data – with provenance, status, and supersession.

- If Anthropic promotes N skill archetypes, that's a cited record to evaluate against, not folklore
- Internal taxonomies live beside published specs, marked internal + candidate
- Competing mental models get compared against the same corpus; superseded, never overwritten

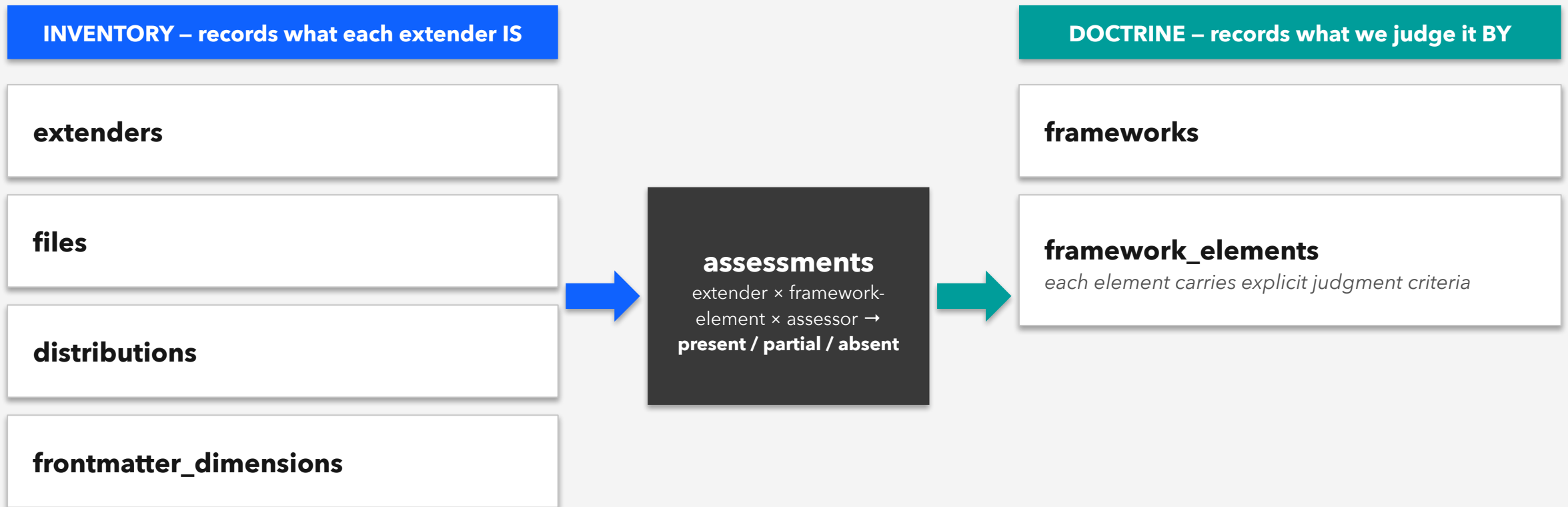
What got built, in one picture

A PocketBase database, an idempotent ingest pipeline, and an assessment loop – with the repo staying the source of truth.

- **37 extenders · 192 files (content + sha256) · 6 frameworks · 662 assessment verdicts**
- The DB is a rebuildable projection: findings become fixes in primitives-core/, then re-ingest
- Runs locally: serve.sh (env-configured), admin UI at 127.0.0.1:8090/_/

Data model: two halves joined by assessments

Seven collections – the inventory records what each extender IS; the doctrine records what we judge it BY.



Inventory side, by example

One row per extender carries everything analysis needs: provenance, parsed frontmatter, the full body, and size metrics.

- Example record (handoff skill): kind=skill, origin=authored, frontmatter JSON, 1,000-word body, file inventory
- files: every file with role (entrypoint/reference/script/asset), full content, sha256
- distributions: code-desk, exec-desk, foreman-kit, diagrams, obsidian-toolkit + 5 standalone wrappers, with membership relations

Doctrine side: the six frameworks

Six frameworks are seeded – two cited to Anthropic docs, two derived from this repo's own enforced rules, two internal candidates.

Framework	Source	Status
anthropic-agent-skills	Anthropic docs	active
claude-code-subagents	Anthropic docs	active
hook-dir-layout	repo lint	active
dotfiles-agents-roster-schema	repo	active
hsb3-skill-archetypes	internal	candidate
skill-section-taxonomy	internal	candidate

Assessor discipline

The assessor field keeps machine facts, judgment, and the adversarial trail from contaminating each other.

- mechanical-v1 (197 rows): regenerated by ingest every run
- judged-v1 (345 rows): judge agents + session adjudication; ingest never touches them
- review-v1 (120 rows): the blind reviewers' verdicts, preserved as the verification record
- Proven: full re-ingest after loading → zero new records, all 465 judgment rows untouched

How judgment was produced

Six judge agents assessed all 23 skills and returned structured JSON with evidence quotes – they never held database credentials.

- Batches of ~4 skills per judge; verdicts validated against the DB's element catalog before loading
- Two reviewers blind-re-derived a stratified 8-skill sample (never saw the judges' answers)
- One builder extended the ingest to hooks + externals, proving its work on a throwaway PocketBase instance

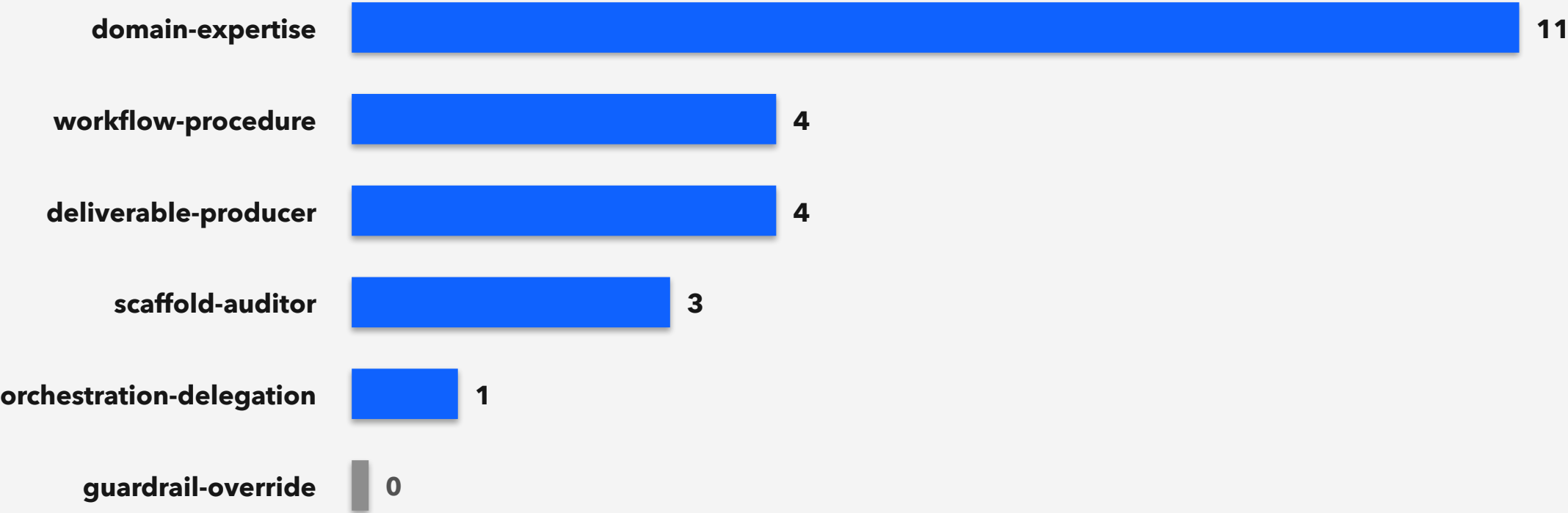
Adversarial review earned its keep

Agreement was high where it should be, and every real disagreement was adjudicated by the session from the sources.

- Primaries: 6/8 exact; sections: 56/72 exact, and 15 of the 16 disagreements were adjacent partial-boundary calls (one hard flip)
- Three adjudications: handoff → workflow-procedure; private-fork → domain-expertise; private-fork integration-partners → absent
- The catch that mattered: the builder patched a schema gap (kind: plugin) only on its throwaway instance – the session gate caught it and fixed schema.py durably (EDB-11)

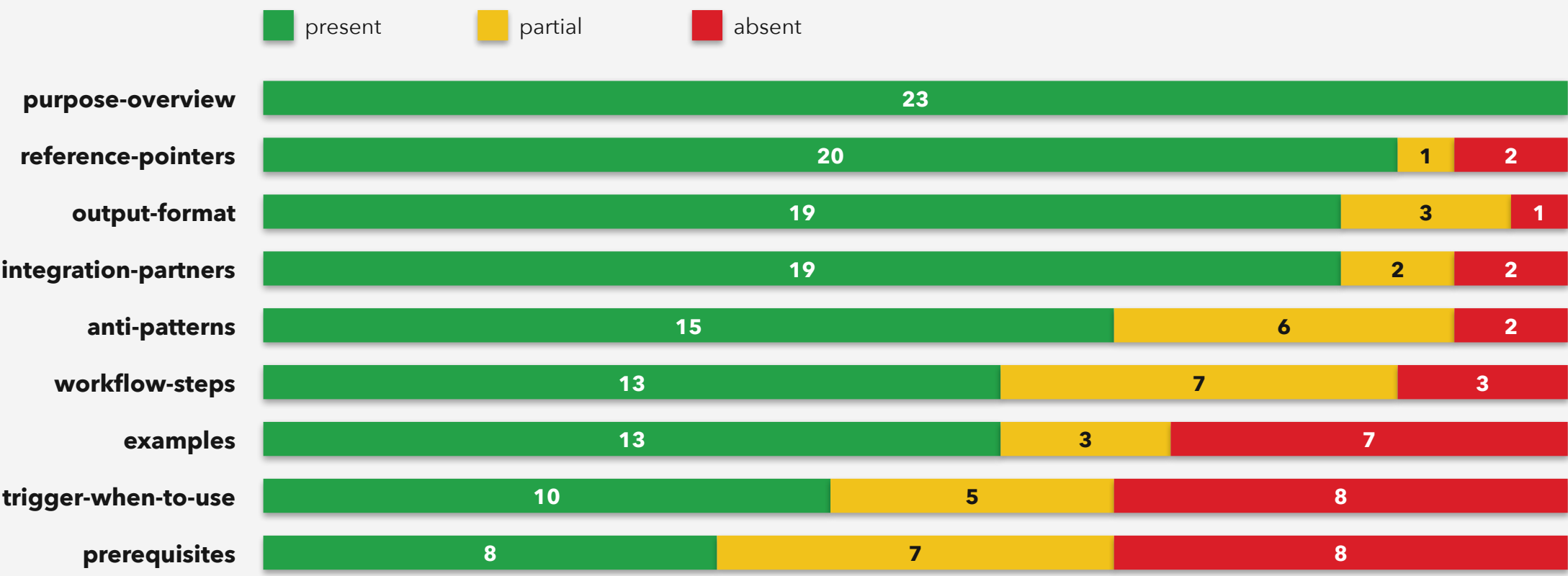
Finding: the catalog's shape

Nearly half the catalog is domain-expertise packs; no skill has guardrail-override as its primary identity.



Finding: section coverage

Two section types are systematically thin – a third of skills have no in-body trigger guidance, and prerequisites is the only section where absent+partial outnumber present.



Findings: confirmed bugs and open questions

The database is already paying rent – one confirmed catalog bug, two conformance violations, three unspecified frontmatter keys.

- EDB-9 (confirmed twice, independently): obsidian-cli cites five reference files that don't exist on disk
- EDB-3: diagrams (653 lines) and obsidian-cli (753 lines) exceed the ≤ 500 -line SKILL.md guideline
- EDB-4: skill metadata ($\times 2$), skill version ($\times 2$), agent memory ($\times 1$) – no spec defines them

Full-surface census

The whole curated surface is now inventoried, and the origin partition matches the repo's own CI output exactly.

- 25 skills (23 authored + 2 external) · 4 agent personas · 4 hooks · 4 external plugins
- Hooks: 16/16 layout checks pass – fully conformant with the ratified hook-dir layout
- Origin: 31 authored · 6 external (pinned upstream + SHA)

Promotion gate scorecard

The charter defines "satisfied" as four checkboxes; two are ticked.

- ☒ Judged pass for every skill, adversarially spot-verified
- ☒ One expansion kind (hooks) end-to-end with its own framework
- ☐ ≥ 3 findings that changed something in the repo (EDB-9 is ready to action)
- ☐ Update-path proof after a real catalog change (falls out of the next one)

Decisions in your court

Four decisions are queued for the owner, in rough order of leverage.

1

Action EDB-9 (obsidian-cli phantom references) – doubles as the update-path proof

2

Fold reviewer calibration notes into judging-criteria v2 before any second pass (EDB-10)

3

Build W4: report.py + PocketBase view collections as the standing analysis surface

4

When the gate is full: promote – stay in `_meta/`, graduate to `scripts/` + make lane, or own repo